UNIVERSITY OF PROFESSIONAL STUDIES, ACCRA

Faculty of Information Technology & Communication Studies

Introduction to IT Service Management

Chapter 1 · ITIL 4 Foundation

Lecture slides prepared for undergraduate students
Department of Information Technology Studies
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How to use these slides

1. **Read before class**
   Work through Chapter 1 of the ITIL 4 Foundation publication first. These slides expand on it, they do not replace it.

2. **Terminology matters**
   ITIL uses ordinary English words with precise technical meanings. Learn the definitions exactly as given.

3. **Think in systems**
   Chapter 1 is a map of the whole framework. Every later chapter zooms into one part of that map.

4. **Localise everything**
   For each concept, find a Ghanaian example: a bank, a telco, a ministry, a university. That is how it sticks.

5. **Assessment focus**
   Foundation-level questions test recall and recognition of components, dimensions and principles.

AGENDA

Session roadmap

I **Service management in the modern world**
Why services dominate modern economies

II **About ITIL 4**
Origins, purpose and what has changed

III **The service value system**
The framework's organising model

IV **The four dimensions model**
Keeping service management holistic

V **Application and contemporary issues**
Ghana context, AI, cloud, security, sustainability

VI **Review and assessment**
Summary, discussion, sample questions

BY THE END OF THIS SESSION YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

Learning objectives

1. **Explain why service management matters**
   Describe the place of services in developed and developing economies, and why almost all services today are IT-enabled.

2. **Define the core vocabulary**
   Use the terms service, value, outcome, cost, risk, utility, warranty, organisation, customer and user precisely.

3. **Describe ITIL and its evolution**
   Trace ITIL from its origins to ITIL 4 and state what ITIL 4 adds to earlier versions.

4. **Outline the ITIL service value system**
   Name the five core components of the SVS and explain how demand is converted into value.

BY THE END OF THIS SESSION YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

Learning objectives (continued)

5 **Explain the service value chain**
Identify the six value chain activities and show how they combine into different value streams.

6 **Recall the guiding principles**
State the seven ITIL guiding principles and apply at least three to a Ghanaian organisational scenario.

7 **Apply the four dimensions model**
Analyse a service using organisations and people, information and technology, partners and suppliers, and value streams and processes.

8 **Discuss contemporary issues**
Debate how AI, cloud, cybersecurity, data protection and sustainability are reshaping service management practice.

Key terms you must own

Service
A means of enabling value co-creation by supporting outcomes customers want, without them owning specific

Value
The perceived benefits, usefulness and importance of something. Perception belongs to the consumer, not the

Outcome
A result for a stakeholder, enabled by one or more outputs.

Output
A tangible or intangible deliverable of an activity.

Cost
Money spent on an activity, and money the consumer no longer has to spend.

Risk
A possible event that could cause harm, or make it harder to achieve objectives.

Utility
Fitness for purpose. What the service does.

Warranty
Fitness for use. How well and how reliably it does it.

PART I

Service management in the modern world

Services now dominate both developed and developing economies. Almost all of them are IT-enabled, which makes service management capability a source of competitive advantage rather than a back-office chore.

The service economy

World Trade Organization data show that services form the largest and fastest-moving component of both developed and developing economies. They are the principal way organisations create value for themselves and for their customers.

Largest

share of output in most modern economies

Fastest

growing and most dynamic sector globally

Almost all

services today are enabled by IT

The consequence for you as an IT professional

- If services carry the economy, and services run on IT, then the quality of IT service management sets a ceiling on national and organisational productivity.
- Creating, expanding and improving service management capability therefore delivers benefit far beyond the IT department.
- This is as true in Accra as it is in Amsterdam: mobile money, digital tax filing and online student registration are all service management problems before they are coding problems.

Services in the Ghanaian economy

Services have been the largest contributor to Ghana's gross domestic product for over a decade, ahead of industry and agriculture. Banking, telecommunications, transport, education, health and public administration are all service industries, and all of them now depend on IT to deliver.

Financial services

Mobile money, instant payment rails, agency banking

Public sector

Digital tax filing, e-procurement, integrated payroll

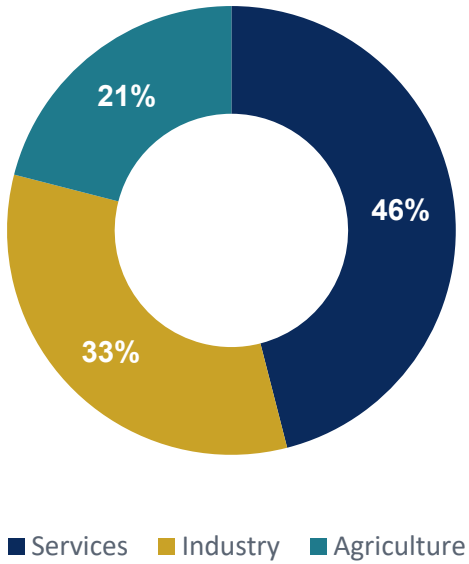
Education

Learning platforms, online admissions, student portals

Health

District health information systems, electronic records

Ghana: indicative sector shares of GDP



Figures are indicative and rounded. Consult the Ghana Statistical Service for current national accounts data.

DEFINITION

What exactly is a service?

A service is a means of enabling value co-creation by facilitating outcomes that customers want to achieve, without the customer having to manage specific costs and risks.

1

Co-creation

Value is not delivered like a parcel. The provider and the consumer produce it together. A learning platform creates no value if nobody logs in.

2

Outcomes, not outputs

The customer wants safe, timely payment of staff, not a payroll database. The database is the output; the paid workforce is the outcome.

3

Transferred cost and risk

The provider absorbs the specific costs and risks of running the capability. That transfer is the essence of the service relationship.

Value, outcomes, costs and risks

Value is the perceived benefit, usefulness and importance of something. Because it is perceived, only the consumer can judge it. Service management works on both sides of the equation: adding benefit while removing cost and risk.

Value is increased when the service

- Supports outcomes the consumer actually wants
- Removes costs the consumer would otherwise carry
- Removes risks the consumer would otherwise bear

Value is destroyed when the service

- Imposes new costs, such as constant rework
- Introduces new risks, such as data exposure
- Delivers outputs nobody asked for

Worked example: a university student portal

Output: a web application with registration and results modules.
Outcome: a student registers on time, from anywhere, and plans the semester with confidence.
Costs and risks removed: no travel to campus, no queueing, no lost paper forms, no dependence on one clerk's availability.

Who is involved in a service relationship?

S

Service provider

The organisation supplying services. Every organisation is a provider to someone.

S

Service consumer

The organisation receiving services. An umbrella term covering the three roles below.

C

Customer

Defines requirements and takes responsibility for the outcomes of consumption.

U

User

Actually uses the service day to day. Often not the person who signed the contract.

S

Sponsor

Authorises the budget. Frequently a fourth voice with a fourth set of priorities.

Exam trap: the customer, the user and the sponsor may be three different people with three different definitions of good service.

What is IT service management?

Service management is the set of specialised organisational capabilities for enabling value for customers in the form of services.

Three words in that definition carry the weight:

Specialised	Not general management. It requires deliberate learning, professional practice and continuing development.
Organisational	It lives in the organisation, not in one heroic individual. It survives staff turnover only if it is institutionalised.
Capabilities	A capability is people plus process plus technology plus partners working together, not a tool you purchase.

ITSM is therefore a management discipline, not a product. No vendor can sell it to you in a box.

Technology is advancing faster than ever

The chapter names four developments that opened fresh opportunities for value creation and turned IT into a business driver and a source of competitive advantage.

1 Cloud computing

Computing consumed as a service. Capacity becomes an operating decision made in minutes rather than a capital project made in quarters.

2 Infrastructure as a service

Servers, storage and networking rented on demand, shifting the provider's attention from hardware ownership to service design.

3 Machine learning

Systems that improve from data. Enables prediction, personalisation and increasingly the automation of service operations themselves.

4 Blockchain

Distributed, tamper-evident records that allow parties who do not trust each other to transact without a central intermediary.

A COMMON MISREADING

Digital transformation is not a technology project

What people assume

- Buy new systems
- Move workloads to the cloud
- Launch an app
- Announce the programme
- Declare victory at go-live

What the chapter says

- An evolution in how the organisation works
- New ways of working, not just new tools
- Designed to flourish amid constant change
- Silos broken down deliberately
- Improvement never actually finishes

Why so many transformations disappoint

- The technology changes but the operating model, incentives and job descriptions do not.
- Governance is announced rather than practised, so decisions still escalate to the same bottleneck.
- Staff are trained on the tool but never on the new way of working the tool assumes.
- Success is measured by the go-live date rather than by outcomes for service consumers.

THE CENTRAL TENSION

Stability versus agility

Organisations must balance the need for stability and predictability against a rising need for operational agility and increased velocity. Neither pole is safe on its own.

Stability and predictability

- Reliable, auditable, compliant
- Protects core records and money movement
- Failure mode: too slow to respond to the market

Agility and velocity

- Fast feedback, frequent small releases
- Responds quickly to changing demand
- Failure mode: fragile services and hidden risk

Multimodal service management

ITIL 4 does not ask you to choose. It expects one organisation to run different services at different speeds at the same time: a core banking ledger changed cautiously under strict control, and a customer-facing mobile feature released weekly. The framework must stretch across both, which is why the value chain is deliberately flexible.

Breaking down silos

Information and technology are becoming thoroughly integrated with other organisational capabilities. Silos are breaking down and cross-functional teams are being used far more widely.

The siloed organisation

- IT sits apart from the business it serves
- Work is handed over between departments
- Each function optimises its own metrics
- Nobody owns the end-to-end outcome
- Blame travels faster than information

The cross-functional organisation

- Mixed teams own a service end to end
- Fewer handovers, therefore fewer queues
- Shared measures of consumer outcomes
- Specialists collaborate rather than escalate
- Learning is collective, not departmental

Service management is changing to support this organisational shift, so that opportunities from new technologies and new ways of working are actually realised rather than merely announced.

PART II

About ITIL 4

ITIL has led the ITSM industry with guidance, training and certification for more than three decades. ITIL 4 reshapes that established body of practice around customer experience, value streams, digital transformation and modern ways of working.

MORE THAN 30 YEARS OF GUIDANCE

The evolution of ITIL

Late 1980s	**Origins**	Developed for the UK government as a library of best practice for managing IT infrastructure.
1990s	**Wide adoption**	Spreads beyond government and beyond Britain; becomes the de facto vocabulary of IT operations.
2000s	**Process era**	Consolidated into a smaller set of books organised around processes and the service lifecycle.
2011	**Refresh**	Lifecycle model retained and clarified; ITSM becomes a mainstream professional discipline.
2019	**ITIL 4**	Re-shapes practice around value streams, customer experience and new ways of working such as Lean, Agile and DevOps.

What ITIL 4 brings up to date

ITIL 4 re-shapes much of the established body of ITSM practice in a wider context, and embraces ways of working that had grown up outside the framework.

Customer experience

Practice is framed around how the service feels to the person using it, not only around internal process compliance.

Value streams

Attention moves to the end-to-end flow of work that produces something valuable, cutting across departments.

Digital transformation

Guidance assumes continuous organisational change rather than a stable environment punctuated by projects.

Lean

Eliminate waste, reduce work in progress, improve flow.

Agile

Short cycles, frequent feedback, adapt to change over following a fixed plan.

DevOps

Development and operations work as one team with shared responsibility and heavy automation.

The purpose of ITIL 4

ITIL 4 provides the guidance organisations need to address new service management challenges and to unlock the potential of modern technology. It is designed to give a flexible, coordinated and integrated system for the effective governance and management of IT-enabled services.

F

Flexible

Adapts to organisations of any size, sector and operating tempo.

C

Coordinated

Aligns the many teams whose work touches a single service.

I

Integrated

Joins IT with the wider organisation rather than isolating it.

G

Governed

Keeps day-to-day operation aligned with strategic direction.

Benefits organisations commonly report

A shared vocabulary across teams and suppliers · fewer repeated incidents · clearer ownership · defensible audit evidence · faster onboarding of new staff · a common basis for outsourcing contracts

The ITIL 4 certification scheme

Foundation is the entry point and the level this course prepares you for. Beyond it, the scheme branches into two complementary streams before converging at the top.

ITIL 4 Foundation — Vocabulary, key concepts, the SVS, the four dimensions and the guiding principles.

Managing Professional

For practitioners running teams and workflows day to day: create, deliver and support; drive stakeholder value; high-velocity IT; direct, plan and improve.

Strategic Leader

For those shaping IT strategy: digital and IT strategy; direct, plan and improve.

Master level, plus extension modules covering areas such as sustainability in digital and IT, acquiring and managing cloud services, and IT asset management.

Scheme details are periodically revised by the scheme owner. Verify current requirements before registering for an examination.

PART III

The structure of the ITIL 4 framework

Two components carry the framework: the service value system, which shows how the parts of an organisation work together to create value, and the four dimensions model, which keeps that work balanced.

Two key components

Everything else in the ITIL 4 publication hangs off these two ideas. Learn them now and the rest of the course becomes navigation rather than memorisation.

1

The service value system

How the various components and activities of the organisation work together to facilitate value creation through IT-enabled services.

2

The four dimensions model

Four perspectives from which every component of the SVS must be considered, so that the approach stays holistic.

The SVS answers how work flows and produces value. The four dimensions answer what must be attended to so that flow is sustainable. Neglect either and the framework collapses into paperwork.

The service value system

The SVS shows how the many components and activities of an organisation combine, flexibly, to turn demand into value. Because they can be combined in many ways, integration and coordination are required to keep the organisation consistent.



Schematic of the service value system, redrawn for teaching purposes. Compare with Figure 1.1 in the publication, which is repeated and explained in Chapter 4.

LEARN THIS LIST

The five core components of the SVS

1. **Guiding principles**
   Universal recommendations that hold true in all circumstances. They shape culture and behaviour from strategy to daily operations.

2. **Governance**
   The means by which the organisation is directed and controlled, keeping operations aligned to the governing body's strategic direction.

3. **Service value chain**
   The operating model. Six interconnected activities that combine into many different value streams.

4. **Practices**
   Sets of organisational resources designed for performing work. Thirty-four practices form a versatile toolset.

5. **Continual improvement**
   A recurring activity at every level, supported by a simple practical model to sustain resilience and agility.

The seven guiding principles

A guiding principle is a recommendation that guides an organisation in all circumstances, regardless of changes in goals, strategy or structure. They create the foundation for culture and behaviour from strategic decision-making to day-to-day operations.

1. **Focus on value**

   Everything traces back to value for the consumer.

2. **Start where you are**

   Assess honestly before discarding what exists.

3. **Progress iteratively with feedback**

   Small steps, timely feedback, adjust.

4. **Collaborate and promote visibility**

   Work with the right people; hide nothing.

5. **Think and work holistically**

   No part performs in isolation from the whole.

6. **Keep it simple and practical**

   Remove anything that fails to produce value.

7. **Optimize and automate**

   Optimise first, then automate what remains.

APPLICATION

Guiding principles in a Ghanaian setting

Focus on value

A rural bank replaces a branch queue with USSD banking because customers value access without travel, not because the technology is fashionable.

Start where you are

Before replacing a functioning student records system, measure what it already does well. Wholesale replacement often destroys undocumented institutional knowledge.

Progress iteratively with feedback

Roll out a new e-procurement module to two ministries, learn, then scale nationally rather than launching everywhere on one date.

Optimize and automate

Automating a broken approval chain simply produces bad decisions faster. Simplify the chain first, then automate what survives.

Governance within the SVS

The SVS includes governance activities that let organisations continually align operations with the strategic direction set by the governing body. Governance is not management, and the difference is examinable.

Governance

- Evaluate the organisation and its environment
- Direct by setting strategy and assigning responsibility
- Monitor performance against that direction
- Sits with the governing body or council

Management

- Plans, builds, runs and improves services
- Works inside the direction that has been set
- Accountable to the governing body
- Sits with executives, managers and teams

Why it matters in the public sector

Ghanaian public institutions operate under statutory oversight, procurement law and audit scrutiny. Governance activities create the evidence trail that shows public money bought the outcomes it was appropriated for.

The service value chain

An operating model for the creation, delivery and continual improvement of services. Six key activities that can be combined in many ways, forming multiple value streams, and flexible enough to suit DevOps, centralised IT or anything between.

1 Plan

Shared understanding of vision, status and direction for all four dimensions.

2 Improve

Continual improvement of products, services and every practice and activity.

3 Engage

Good understanding of stakeholder needs, transparency and strong relationships.

4 Design & transition

Products and services continually meet expectations for quality, cost and time to market.

5 Obtain / build

Service components are available where and when they are needed, to agreed specification.

6 Deliver & support

Services are delivered and supported to agreed specifications and stakeholder expectations.

Every activity can call on any of the practices, and any activity can pass work to any other. There is no fixed sequence.

WORKED EXAMPLE

From value chain to value stream

A value stream is a specific route through the chain for a specific type of work. Here is one for a lecturer who cannot access the results-upload system on a deadline day.

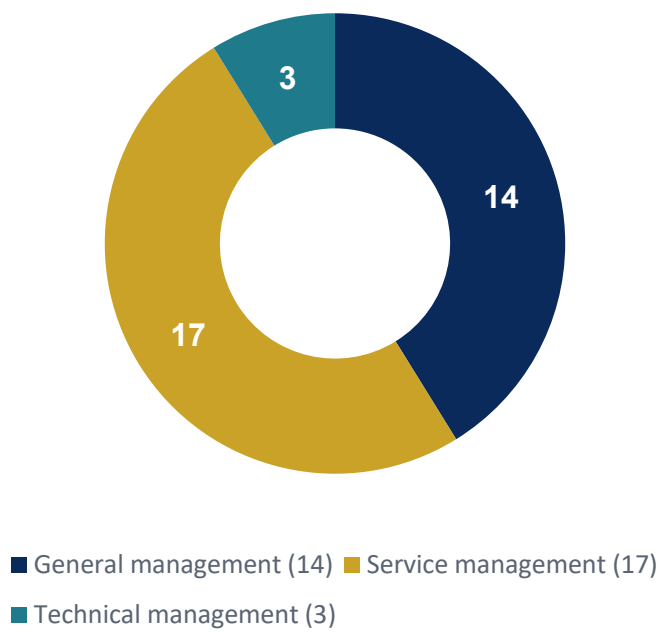
1	**Engage**	The lecturer reports the failure to the service desk, which records and classifies it.
2	**Deliver & support**	First-line attempts known workarounds; the incident is escalated to application support.
3	**Obtain / build**	A configuration fix is prepared and tested in a non-production environment.
4	**Design & transition**	The fix is authorised through change enablement and released with a rollback plan.
5	**Deliver & support**	Service is restored, the lecturer confirms upload works, the record is closed.
6	**Improve**	Problem management asks why it failed at deadline and removes the underlying cause.

Deliver and support appears twice; Plan does not appear at all. Different work takes different routes through the same six activities.

The ITIL practices

A practice is a set of organisational resources designed for performing work or accomplishing an objective. Each practice supports multiple value chain activities, which is what makes the chain flexible in the first place.

34 practices in three categories



General management practices

Adapted from general business management for service management use, such as risk, supplier and workforce management.

Service management practices

Developed within service management and ITSM, such as incident, problem and service level management.

Technical management practices

Adapted from technology management for service management use, such as deployment and infrastructure management.

General management practices

1. Architecture management
2. Continual improvement
3. Information security management
4. Knowledge management
5. Measurement and reporting
6. Organizational change management
7. Portfolio management
8. Project management
9. Relationship management
10. Risk management
11. Service financial management
12. Strategy management
13. Supplier management
14. Workforce and talent management

These come from general business management and were adapted for service management. Note that continual improvement appears both as an SVS component and as a practice.

Service management practices

Availability management	Business analysis	Capacity and performance management
Change enablement	Incident management	IT asset management
Monitoring and event management	Problem management	Release management
Service catalogue management	Service configuration management	Service continuity management
Service design	Service desk	Service level management
Service request management	Service validation and testing	

Five of these carry most of the daily workload in any IT department: service desk, incident, problem, change enablement and service request management.

Technical management practices

1

Deployment management

Moving new or changed hardware, software, documentation and processes into live environments, reliably and repeatably.

2

Infrastructure and platform management

Overseeing the infrastructure and platforms used by the organisation, including cloud services and the monitoring of technology solutions.

3

Software development and management

Ensuring applications meet stakeholder needs in terms of functionality, reliability, maintainability, compliance and auditability.

Only three, but they are where cloud adoption, automation and DevOps pressure is felt most sharply today.

Continual improvement

Every component of the SVS is supported by continual improvement. ITIL offers a simple, practical model of seven questions that keeps an organisation resilient and agile in a constantly changing environment.

1. What is the vision?
2. Where are we now?
3. Where do we want to be?
4. How do we get there?
5. Take action
6. Did we get there?
7. **How do we keep the momentum going?**

PART IV

The four dimensions model

To keep service management holistic, ITIL 4 asks you to consider every component of the SVS from four perspectives. Give each an appropriate amount of focus and the system stays balanced and effective.

The four dimensions of service management

1

Organisations and people

Structures, roles, culture, competence and capacity

2

Information and technology

The information the service handles and the technology that supports it

3

Partners and suppliers

The organisations involved in design, deployment, delivery and support

4

Value streams and processes

How the parts of the organisation work together to enable value creation

All four apply to every service and to every component of the SVS. They are perspectives to be balanced, not departments to be staffed.

Dimension 1: Organisations and people

An organisation's effectiveness cannot be assured by a formal structure or system of authority alone. It also needs a culture that supports its objectives and the right level of capacity and competence among its workforce.

1. **Structure and roles**
   Who decides, who delivers, who is accountable when a service fails at 2 a.m.

2. **Culture**
   Shared values and behaviours. A no-blame culture surfaces problems; a punitive one buries them.

3. **Competence and capacity**
   Enough people, with the right current skills, available to do the work.

4. **Communication and collaboration**
   Everyone understands their contribution to creating value.

Local reality: skills retention. Trained ITSM staff are mobile and internationally marketable, so workforce planning is a service risk, not an HR footnote.

Dimension 2: Information and technology

Information

- What information does the service create, manage and use?
- What are the requirements for confidentiality, integrity and availability?
- How is information archived, retained and disposed of?
- Who may see it, and under what legal authority?

Technology

- Is the technology compatible with current architecture?
- Does it raise regulatory, compliance or security concerns?
- Will it still be supported and viable in five years?
- Do we have, or can we buy, the skills to run it?

Regulatory anchor for Ghanaian practice

Personal data handled by a service falls under the Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843), administered by the Data Protection Commission. Critical information infrastructure and incident reporting obligations arise under the Cybersecurity Act, 2020 (Act 1038). Both belong to this dimension, not to a separate legal silo.

Dimension 3: Partners and suppliers

Every organisation depends on others. This dimension covers the relationships involved in the design, development, deployment, delivery, support and continual improvement of services, and the contracts that hold them together.

Strategic focus	Do we differentiate ourselves by doing this in-house, or is it a commodity best bought?
Corporate culture	Some organisations have a long-standing bias for or against outsourcing; recognise it.
Resource scarcity	If the skill or asset is scarce locally, a partner may be the only realistic route.
Cost and demand patterns	Volatile demand favours consumption-based sourcing over owned capacity.
Regulatory constraints	Data residency, procurement law and sector regulation may narrow the options.

Public institutions in Ghana source under the Public Procurement Act, 2003 (Act 663), as amended.

Dimension 4: Value streams and processes

Value stream

A series of steps an organisation takes to create and deliver products and services to a consumer. It cuts across teams and follows the work, not the org chart.

Process

A set of interrelated activities that transforms inputs into outputs. It defines the sequence and the dependencies, and turns inputs into results.

Questions this dimension forces you to ask

- ? What is the model of value creation here, and where does the work actually start?
- ? Which activities add value for the consumer, and which merely add delay?
- ? Where does work stop and wait, and who is waiting for whom?
- ? How do we know the flow has improved rather than simply moved the queue elsewhere?

External factors shaping all four dimensions

The four dimensions are constrained by external factors the organisation does not control. They must be monitored and responded to, not wished away.

P Political

Government policy on digitalisation, public sector reform, sector regulation.

E Economic

Exchange rate movement on cloud and licence costs, inflation, funding cycles.

S Social

Skills supply, mobile-first user expectations, digital literacy, urban-rural divides.

T Technological

Cloud maturity, AI capability, connectivity, undersea cable dependency.

L Legal

Data protection, cybersecurity, procurement and consumer protection statutes.

E Environmental

Power reliability, cooling, e-waste handling, sustainability expectations.

DIAGNOSTIC

What neglecting a dimension looks like

Organisations and people

A modern platform nobody knows how to run. Tickets pile up because two people hold all the knowledge.

Information and technology

Clean processes running on unsupported software, with personal data stored wherever it happened to land.

Partners and suppliers

Contracts that promise availability nobody measures, and a vendor whose incentives reward slow resolution.

Value streams and processes

Every team hits its own targets while the consumer still waits six weeks for a working laptop.

Balance is the whole point. An organisation that gives all four an appropriate amount of focus keeps its SVS effective.

PART V

Application and contemporary issues

A framework only earns its keep when it is applied. We work a Ghanaian case, then examine the forces reshaping service management practice right now.

TEACHING CASE

Case study: Sankofa Car Hire, Accra

The situation

Sankofa Car Hire has rented vehicles from three Accra branches for eleven years, taking bookings by telephone and walk-in. Two ride-hailing platforms and a peer-to-peer car-share app have entered the market. Corporate clients now expect to book, extend and pay online, and to see a vehicle's location in real time. Sankofa's booking system was written for one branch, runs on an unsupported database, and is maintained by a single contractor.

The chief information officer's stated vision

To become the most trusted vehicle-hire brand in West Africa: keeping the service quality and competitive rates the firm is known for, while competing on the whole travel experience rather than on the vehicle alone. Booking must be possible from a phone in under two minutes, at any hour, with the same answer from every branch.

Question for the class: is this a technology problem, a service management problem, or both? Justify your answer using the definition of a service.

CASE ANALYSIS

Sankofa through the four dimensions

1

Organisations and people

One contractor is a single point of failure. Branch staff have never been trained to support a digital channel, and no one owns the booking service end to end.

2

Information and technology

Customer identity documents and payment data sit in an unsupported database, raising obligations under the Data Protection Act. Real-time vehicle location is a new class of information the firm has never handled.

3

Partners and suppliers

A payment aggregator, a telematics vendor and a cloud host must now be selected, contracted and measured. Supplier failure becomes service failure.

4

Value streams and processes

The booking stream still assumes a telephone call and a paper form. Digitising the form without redesigning the stream would simply move the queue online.

CASE ANALYSIS

Sankofa through the value chain

Plan	Agree the vision, the target customer segments and the investment envelope across all four dimensions.
Engage	Interview corporate clients and walk-in customers. Involve branch staff early; they know why bookings fail.
Design & transition	Design the booking journey, the branch handover and the support model together, not sequentially.
Obtain / build	Select the payment and telematics partners; build or configure the booking platform.
Deliver & support	Stand up a service desk that answers both customers and branches, with defined targets.
Improve	Instrument the journey. Measure abandoned bookings and time-to-vehicle, then remove the biggest cause each month.

Guiding principles at work here: start where you are, progress iteratively with feedback, and focus on value.

Contemporary issues in service management

Chapter 1 was written for a moment that has already moved on. These five forces are reshaping how the SVS is applied in practice, and each will appear again later in the course.

1. **Artificial intelligence and AIOps**

   Automating detection, diagnosis and increasingly the resolution of service issues.

2. **Cloud, platform engineering and SRE**

   New operating models that blur the line between building and running a service.

3. **Cybersecurity and data protection**

   Security as a design input and a legal obligation, not a control added at the end.

4. **Sustainability and green IT**

   Energy, e-waste and reporting expectations entering service design decisions.

5. **Skills, hybrid work and digital public services**

   Where the people and the demand are actually going in this market.

CONTEMPORARY ISSUE 1

Artificial intelligence in service management

Where it is already working

- Automatic classification and routing of tickets
- Anomaly detection across noisy monitoring data
- Event correlation that suppresses alert storms
- Conversational self-service for routine requests
- Drafting knowledge articles from resolved incidents

Where caution is required

- Confident but wrong answers reaching users unchecked
- Personal data leaving the jurisdiction through a tool
- Automation applied to a broken process, at speed
- Loss of the tacit knowledge junior staff gain by triaging
- Accountability blurred when a model makes the call

Read it through the guiding principles

Optimize and automate says optimise first. An AI layer over a badly designed request process industrialises the defect. Keep it simple and practical says prefer the smallest intervention that works. Focus on value asks whether the consumer's outcome actually improved, or only the provider's cost.

CONTEMPORARY ISSUE 2

Cloud, platform engineering and site reliability

Cloud as the default

New services are increasingly designed for cloud first. This shifts effort from procurement and installation towards architecture, cost control and supplier management.

Platform engineering

Internal platform teams provide self-service capability to developers. The platform becomes a product with its own consumers, its own service levels and its own support model.

Site reliability engineering

Reliability treated as an engineering discipline with explicit objectives and error budgets, giving an evidence-based way to balance change velocity against stability.

FinOps and currency exposure

Consumption pricing is usually dollar-denominated. In a depreciating-currency environment, cost management becomes a monthly service management activity, not an annual budgeting one.

CONTEMPORARY ISSUE 3

Cybersecurity and data protection

Security is now a design input to every service and a statutory obligation with named enforcement bodies. In ITIL terms it sits in information and technology, is delivered through information security management, and is governed like any other risk.

Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843)

Registration of data controllers, lawful processing, data subject rights, and the role of the Data Protection Commission.

Cybersecurity Act, 2020 (Act 1038)

Establishes the Cyber Security Authority, protects critical information infrastructure, and creates incident reporting duties.

Sector regulation

Bank of Ghana and National Communications Authority directives impose additional resilience and reporting expectations.

Practical consequence

Incident management must be able to recognise a reportable security incident and escalate within statutory timeframes.

Statutes are amended from time to time. Confirm the current text before relying on it professionally.

CONTEMPORARY ISSUE 4

Sustainability and green IT

1

Energy and resilience

Unreliable grid supply forces generators, inverters and battery estates into the service design. Each is an asset to manage, a cost to control and an emissions source to account for.

2

Equipment lifecycle

Procurement, refurbishment, redeployment and disposal are service management decisions. Electronic waste handling is regulated and reputationally sensitive.

3

Efficient design

Right-sizing workloads, retiring zombie servers and scheduling non-urgent batch work reduce both cost and consumption. The same action serves two objectives.

4

Reporting expectations

Investors, development partners and large customers increasingly ask for environmental data. Measurement and reporting becomes the practice that answers them.

Sustainability in digital and IT is now a formal extension module in the ITIL scheme, which signals where professional expectations are heading.

CONTEMPORARY ISSUE 5

Skills, hybrid work and digital public services

Workforce

- Certified ITSM skills are internationally portable, so retention is a genuine service continuity risk.
- Hybrid and remote work has permanently changed what the service desk supports and where users are.
- Support now extends to home connectivity, personal devices and household power arrangements.

Public service demand

- Digital public services are expanding: tax filing, business registration, passports, procurement and payments.
- Citizens increasingly experience the state through a mobile interface, making government an IT service provider.
- Every one of those platforms needs incident, change, continuity and supplier management to function.

What this means for your career

- Demand for people who can run services, not merely build systems, is growing faster than supply.
- Framework literacy plus local regulatory knowledge is a rare and defensible combination.
- Foundation certification is a low-cost, portable signal of that literacy to any employer.

POSITIONING

ITIL alongside other frameworks

These are not rivals competing for the same slot. Knowing where each belongs prevents a great deal of wasted argument.

ITIL 4	What good service management looks like end to end	Complementary. Provides the operating model and shared vocabulary.
COBIT	Governance and management of enterprise information and technology	Sits above ITIL. Answers whether the right things are being directed and controlled.
ISO/IEC 20000	A certifiable standard for a service management system	Certifies. ITIL practice supplies much of the evidence an audit will ask for.
DevOps	Culture and automation joining development and operations	Absorbed. ITIL 4 explicitly embraces it rather than competing with it.
Agile and Lean	Iterative delivery; elimination of waste and improved flow	Absorbed. Reflected in the guiding principles and the value chain's flexibility.

COMMON ERRORS

Six misconceptions to avoid

x ITIL is a set of rules to obey

It is guidance to be adopted and adapted. Blind compliance contradicts the guiding principles.

x ITIL is software you can buy

Tools support practices. No purchase creates organisational capability.

x ITIL is anti-Agile

ITIL 4 explicitly embraces Lean, Agile and DevOps as ways of working.

x ITIL is only for large organisations

The practices scale down. A five-person team still needs incident and change discipline.

x Value is what the provider delivers

Value is perceived by the consumer and co-created. The provider alone cannot declare it.

x Adoption is a project with an end date

Continual improvement is a permanent component of the SVS, not a closing phase.

PART VI

Review and assessment

Consolidate the chapter, test recall against the learning objectives, and prepare for the tutorial discussion.

Chapter summary

1. Services are the largest and most dynamic part of modern economies, and nearly all of them are IT-enabled.
2. A service enables value co-creation by supporting outcomes while removing specific costs and risks from the consumer.
3. Value is perceived by the consumer, which means the provider cannot declare success unilaterally.
4. Service management is a set of specialised organisational capabilities, not a product or a tool.
5. Cloud, IaaS, machine learning and blockchain turned IT into a business driver and a strategic capability.
6. Digital transformation is a change in how organisations work, not merely a change of technology.
7. The ITIL SVS shows how opportunity and demand are converted into value through five core components.
8. The service value chain's six activities combine flexibly into many different value streams.
9. Four dimensions must each receive appropriate focus for the SVS to stay balanced and effective.
10. Continual improvement supports every component and never reaches a final state.

Discussion questions

1. Choose a service you personally consume from a Ghanaian institution. Identify its outputs, the outcomes it enables, and the costs and risks it removes from you.

2. Your faculty wants to launch an online results-release service. Analyse it across all four dimensions and state which one is most likely to be neglected, with reasons.

3. Argue for or against the claim that digital transformation in the Ghanaian public sector has been mainly technological rather than organisational.

4. Which two guiding principles would most improve service delivery in an organisation you know well? Justify your choice with evidence.

5. Should a service desk deploy an AI assistant before or after redesigning its request process? Defend your position using optimize and automate.

SAMPLE QUESTIONS

Check your understanding

1. Which of the following best describes value?

(a) The cost of providing a service (b) The perceived benefits, usefulness and importance of something (c) The revenue a provider earns (d) The number of outputs delivered

2. How many activities make up the ITIL service value chain?

(a) Four (b) Five (c) Six (d) Seven

3. Which is NOT one of the four dimensions of service management?

(a) Organisations and people (b) Partners and suppliers (c) Governance and compliance (d) Value streams and processes

4. Which SVS component provides recommendations that hold in all circumstances?

(a) Practices (b) Guiding principles (c) The service value chain (d) Governance

5. Continual improvement in ITIL 4 is best described as

(a) A one-off project (b) A component of the SVS and also a practice (c) A technical management practice (d) A stage of the lifecycle

Answers and reasoning

1 - (b)	Value is perceived. Because perception belongs to the consumer, the provider cannot declare value unilaterally.
2 - (c)	Six: plan, improve, engage, design and transition, obtain or build, and deliver and support.
3 - (c)	Governance is a component of the SVS, not one of the four dimensions. This distractor appears often.
4 - (b)	Guiding principles are universal recommendations that hold regardless of changes in goals, strategy or structure.
5 - (b)	It appears twice by design: as a core SVS component and as a general management practice.

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ITIL is a registered trade mark of its owner. These slides are original teaching material prepared for UPSA students; concepts are summarised and paraphrased, and students must read the official publication itself.

End of Chapter 1

Next: the four dimensions of service management

Before the next session
Read Chapter 2 of the publication, and bring one service you use daily, analysed across the four dimensions.

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